



My master research

- Fashion designer > master game technologies
- Running these guilds as part of my master research
- Needs to be recorded for documentation
- Your input is my data
- Helps me graduate ☺
- In turn: Ask me for help, feedback etc on your costume work!



To introduce myself quickly, I am Imara, my previous study was fashion design and I am now doing my master in game technologies.

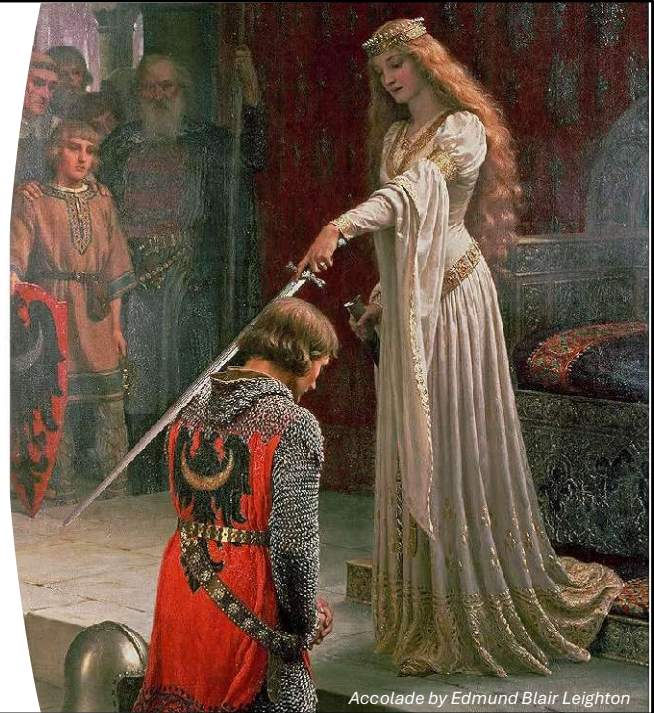
I've started running these guilds as part of my master research, and it's about figuring out which costume design principles are important for video game design, and I will find this out by observing how you guys interact with and react to the guild content I have prepared for you guys

Your input, thoughts, reflections, work you show me if all part of the data I'm gathering. Your input will help me graduate

And in turn I am always available if you need help, feedback or anything else.

Acknowledgements

- This is 800 years of history in < 1 hour
- Goal is to introduce you to medieval and renaissance, so you know what exists
- So you can research further



I just want to say that this will be a presentation where about 800 years of history is forced into less than 1 hour

My goal with these history sessions is to introduce you to each era so you can start recognising them, learn their logic (construction, layering, social status) So you can research further.

Also sorry if I mispronounce anything, so many words ive never heard spoken aloud

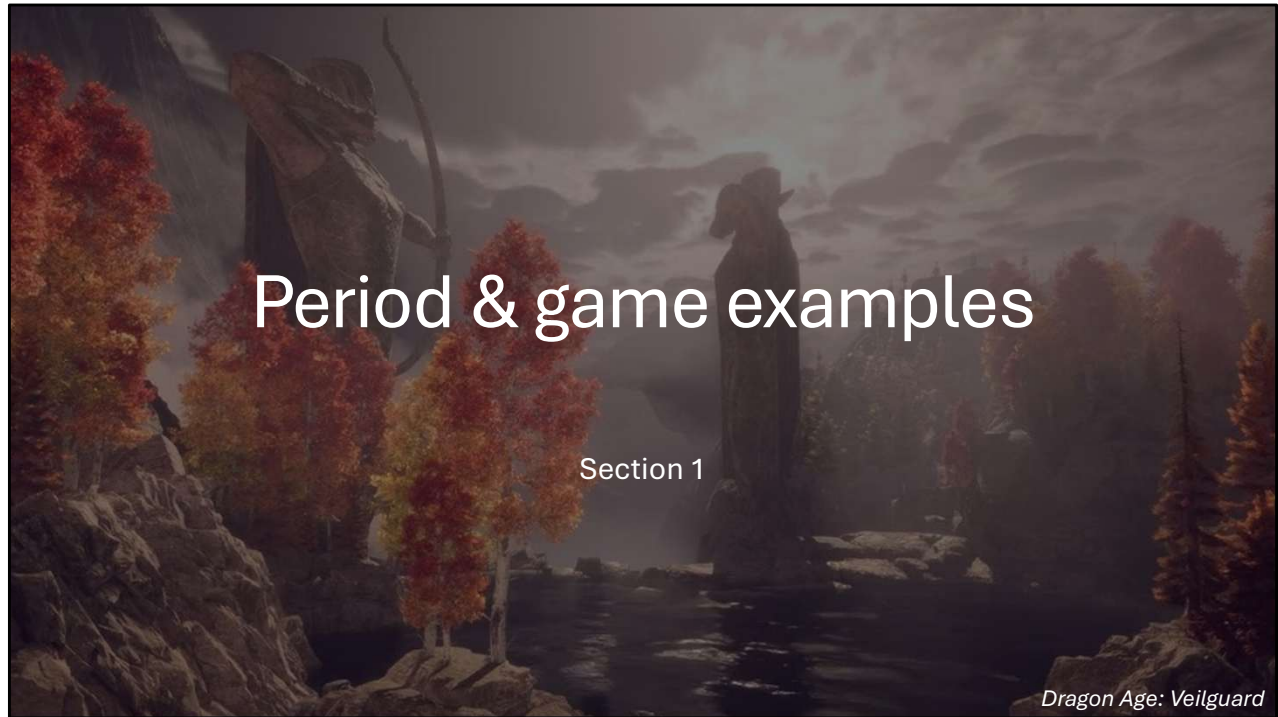
Agenda

1. Period & game examples
2. Silhouette & key garments
3. Social hierarchy
4. Materials, textiles & dyes
5. Construction & details
6. Special topics
7. Discussion & reflection



Witcher 3: Blood and wine

The agenda for today covers various aspects of costume principles, from silhouette to construction.



Lets start with some examples of this period and how it's used in games

Introduction

- THE most common setting in AAA games (~25-30% of major releases)
- **Fantasy genre default aesthetic**



Elden ring



Skyrim

The medieval and renaissance period is the most commonly used historical period for triple A games.

In fantasy this is kind of the default aesthetic because players can easily understand the world

Period explanation

Medieval

- Early: 400-1100
- High: 1100-1300
- Late: 1300-1500



A quick overview of how medieval is divided into three parts the Early Middle Ages (400–1100) focused on tunics, the High Middle Ages (1100–1300) introduced layering and richer fabrics, and the Late Middle Ages (1300–1500) brought fitted tailoring and rapid trend changes.

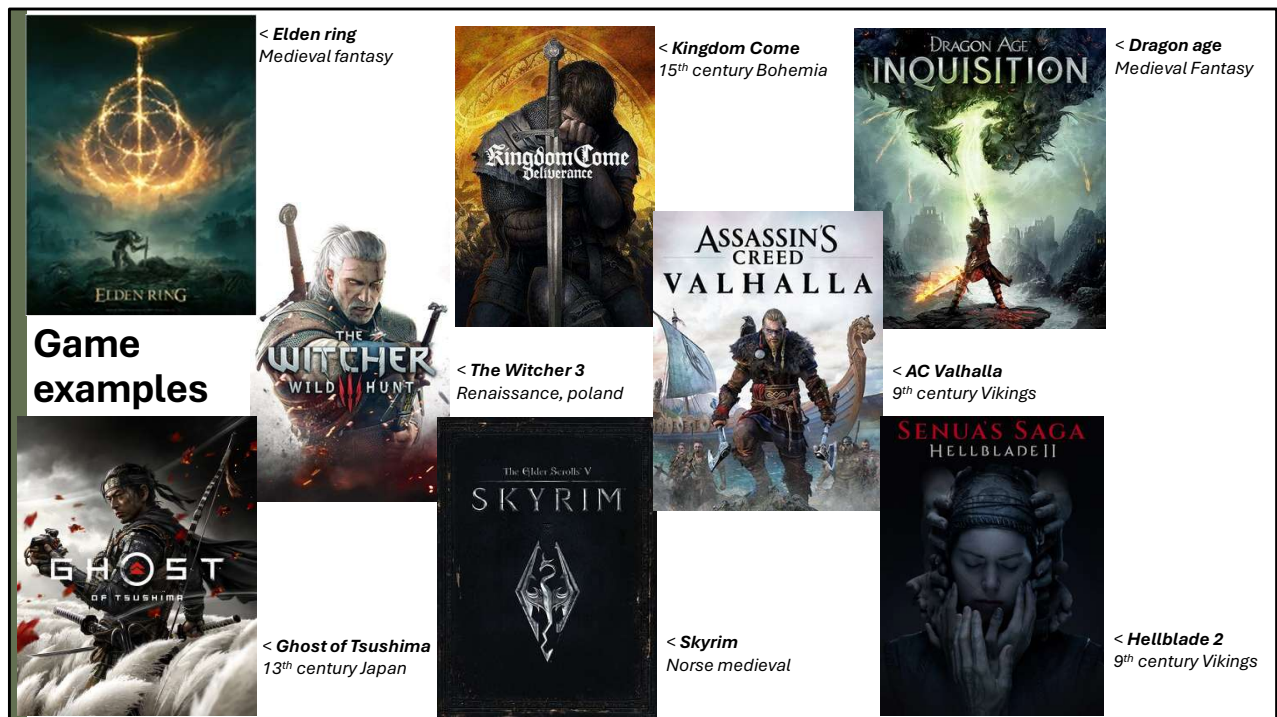
Period explanation

Renaissance

- Early: 1400-1500
- High: 1520-1550
- Late: 1500-1600



The late medieval period with its start in tailoring, bridges into the early renaissance where the Early Renaissance (15th century), highlights Italian luxury; the High Renaissance (1520s–1550s), features broad-shouldered silhouettes and slashing; and the late 16th-century Spanish/Elizabethan era, characterized by stiff ruffs, rigid bodices, and darker, heavily decorated clothing.



Here are a few examples of the games that are inspired by these periods. You might have played a few of them yourself

- Elden Ring (medieval fantasy)
- The Witcher 3 (Renaissance Poland-inspired)
- Kingdom Come: Deliverance II (historical 15th century Bohemia)
- Skyrim (Norse-medieval)
- Dragon Age series (medieval fantasy)
- Ghost of Tsushima (13th century Japan)
- Assassin's Creed Valhalla (9th century Viking)

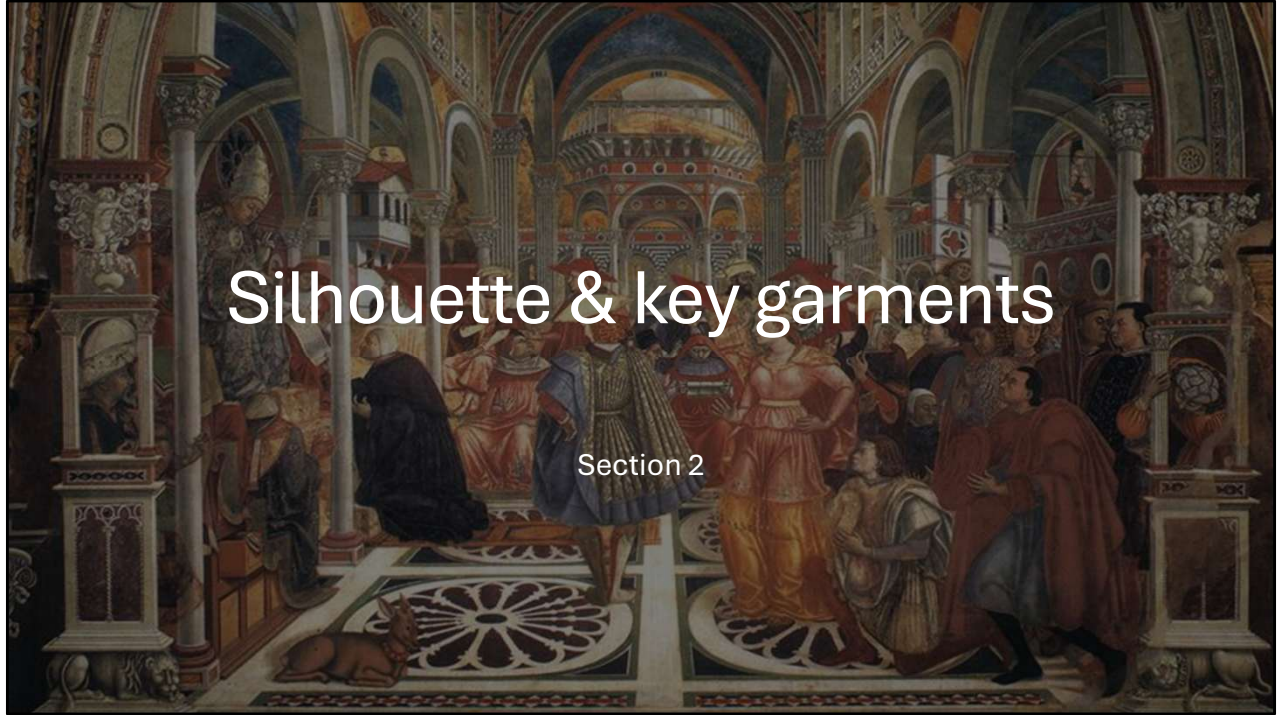
Key take-aways

- If you could only learn one historical period for game char design, medieval is it.
- Most fantasy worlds default to medieval aesthetics because the visual language is instantly understandable



What we have learned from these game examples is that a lot of popular games are inspired by this era

It's visual language is easy to understand and is largely used in a whole range of games.



Alright, lets get into the silhouette and key garments of these periods

Defining silhouette

Medieval (1200-1400):

- Long, layered, flowing - vertical emphasis
- Simple A-line tunics
- Loose, practical for movement
- Hood/cowl creates distinctive head shape



Starting with medieval, the defining silhouette was mostly coming from the tunics they wore.

At this point, they didn't know much about tailoring so the garments were kind of large rectangles with more geometric shapes added for movement

Defining silhouette

Renaissance (1400-1600):

- Structured, puffed, horizontal emphasis
- Broad shoulders (slashed sleeves, puffed)
- Defined waist (doublets)
- Stiff bodies
- Codpieces



Then de renaissance was when tailoring really started, the fashion became more defined, fitted and had strong emphasis on body proportions

Key garments - medieval

1. Tunic
2. Chemise/Shirt (Underlayer)
3. Hose (Leg Covering)
4. Gambeson (Quilted Armor)
5. Surcoat (Outer Layer)



1. Tunic

Foundation garment for all genders and classes, Simple T-shape or rectangle construction

2. Chemise/Shirt (Underlayer)

Worn next to skin under everything, Simple construction, loose fit, Visible at neckline and wrists (white/cream fabric shows status - harder to keep clean)

3. Hose (Leg Covering)

Essentially fabric leg tubes, fitted to leg, Tied to belt or laced to doublet/braies, Later period: Joined at crotch, earlier: Separate legs

4. Gambeson (Quilted Armor)

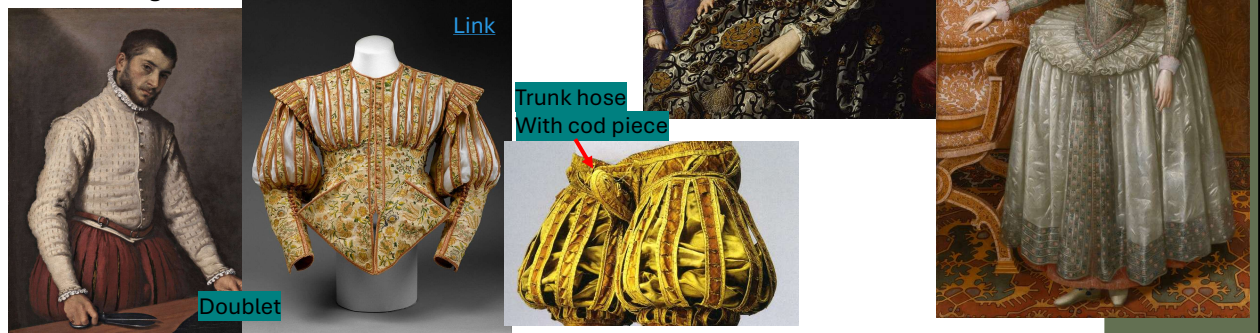
Two layers fabric with padding between (wool, linen stuffing), Quilted in channels (vertical or diamond pattern), Most common armor type (cheaper than metal)

5. Surcoat (Outer Layer)

Sleeveless overdress/overtunic, Worn over armor or tunic, Often displays heraldry or status through decoration

Key garments - renaissance

1. Doublet
2. Trunk Hose/Breeches
3. Codpiece
4. Stiff Bodice/Stays
5. Farthingale



1. Doublet (Men's Fitted Jacket)

Multiple shaped panels, tailored fit, Structured with interlining/padding, Covered in detail already

2. Trunk Hose/Breeches (Men's Leg Wear)

Puffed, padded upper leg garment, Slashed/paned (decorative cuts showing contrasting lining), Tied to doublet with points (laces)

3. Codpiece (Men's... Genital Covering)

Triangular pouch, ties or buttons to breeches, Status symbol (size and decoration = wealth/virility display), Genuinely historically accurate, awkward but relevant

4. Stiff Bodice/Stays (Women's Structured Undergarment)

Multiple panels with boning, Creates cone-shaped torso, Covered in detail already

5. Farthingale (Women's Skirt Structure)

Hooped petticoat (wire, wood, or whalebone rings), Creates dome or drum-shaped skirt silhouette (Spanish farthingale = cone, French/Elizabethan = drum), Skirt fabric hangs from structure, not body

Armour silhouettes

Cloth (gambeson)

→

Chainmail

→

Plate



The armour silhouettes of this era is visualised here
Every ranking of soldier/knight was a progression of protection

Armour silhouettes

Fantasy archetypes:



Mage robes (flowing)



Rogue leather (fitted)



Knight plate (bulky)

These three archetypes followed out of this era, the mages with the long robes, often wool

Rogue in leather with cloak and hood in a more fitted outfit

And lastly the knight in plate armour



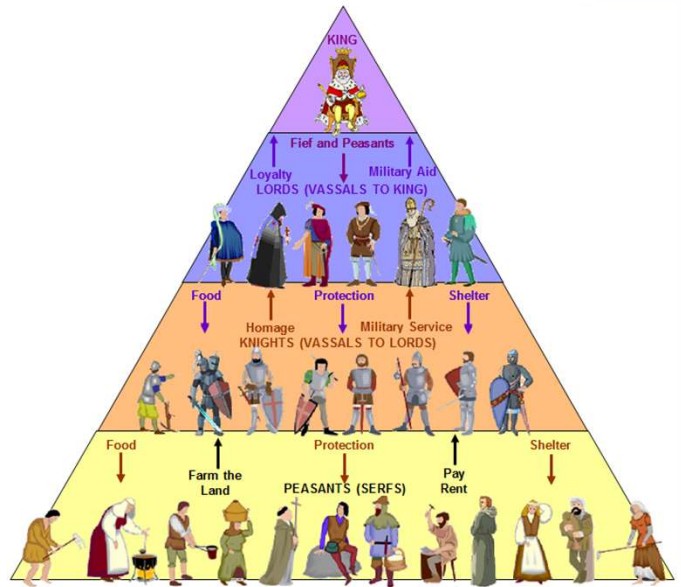
Social hierarchy

Section 3

Lets get into the social hierarchy

Social hierarchy

ROYALTY → NOBILITY → KNIGHTS/CLERGY
→ MERCHANTS → CRAFTSMEN →
PEASANTS → SERFS



In medieval and Renaissance society, you were essentially born into your social position and stayed there - a peasant's child became a peasant, a noble's child inherited nobility, with very little opportunity to move between classes.

Visual markers of status

FABRIC QUALITY:

- **High Status:** Silk, velvet, fine wool, fur trim
- **Middle Status:** Good wool, linen
- **Low Status:** Rough wool, hemp, patched materials



COLOR (Dye = Money):

- **Expensive:** Purple (tyrian), deep reds (cochineal), rich blues (indigo)
- **Moderate:** Greens, yellows, lighter blues
- **Cheap:** Browns, grays, undyed natural (beige/cream)

Both era's used the same visual markers of status through fabrics
You can see here what social class was dressed in what.
In a bit I will go into the specific of each and how that might look like
Your status allowed you to get access to specific fabrics or dyes, but also what
profession you had played a role in what you could wear in terms of practicality.
For example A worker would never wear white as that is hard to keep clean

Visual markers of status

LAYERS = WEALTH:

- Peasant: 1-2 layers (shirt, tunic OR dress)
- Merchant: 3-4 layers (shirt, tunic, surcoat, cloak)
- Noble: 5+ layers (chemise, kirtle, gown, surcoat, mantle, jewellery)



Layers also indicated how well off you were.

The more layers you wore was influenced by your wealth and how much manual labour you did during the day.

Visual markers of status

ORNAMENTATION:

- Embroidery density
- Jewellery (metals: gold vs. copper)
- Trim quality (fur, brocade)
- Accessory count



Ornamentation was again also part of how wealthy you were.

A middle class person might have fur from common animals like sheep around the shoulders for warmth

Where a wealthy person would wear expensive fur like marten, fox or lynx

Visual markers of status

ARMOR HIERARCHY:

- **Peasant militia:** Gambeson (quilted cloth), maybe leather, farming tools as weapons
- **Man-at-arms:** Chainmail, basic helmet, sword
- **Knight:** Full plate (expensive!), heraldry, warhorse, decorated
- **Noble knight:** Ornate armour, gilding, plumes, custom heraldry



In the army you could also quickly recognise the hierarchy from what they are wearing

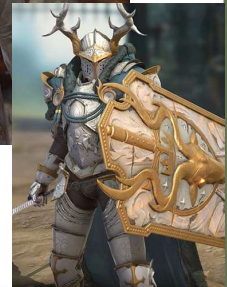
Lower ranks in the army would wear just cloth gambesons

Then chainmail and a surcoat with your alliance on it

And further up you would get full plate armour which could be gilded

Game design application

- **Quest giver = Noble?**
Rich colours, multiple layers, jewellery
- **Blacksmith NPC?**
Practical, leather apron, soot stains, middle-quality fabric
- **Random villager?**
1-2 earth-toned layers, patched, simple
- **Boss enemy knight?**
Most ornate armour in the faction



You can use hierarchy as a design tool. Not everyone needs elaborate outfits. You can make villagers stay simple and in the background, but if the blacksmith is important in the story, give his outfit a bit more detail. And finally if theres a boss enemy like a knight, give him the most ornate armour so the player knows this will be a challenge and visually stands out from the rest

Game examples

Witcher 3:

Peasants in browns/greys,

Nobles in rich colours and
embellishment



Then here are 2 more game examples of games I think do costume design in terms of hierarchy well

In the witcher the peasants are clearly recognisable in their browns and greys, dirty clothing that has seen better days

While nobles are visually unique with rich colours and lots of embellishment

Game examples

Kingdom Come Deliverance:

Detailed class distinction in every NPC



Kingdom come has taken it a step further, their costumes have clear class distinctions

And are historically accurate, so if you ever need some inspiration for medieval npcs, this game is quite useful



The next topic is materials, textiles and dyes

Source image: <https://postej-stew.dk/2019/05/medieval-fabrics-part-2/>

Materials

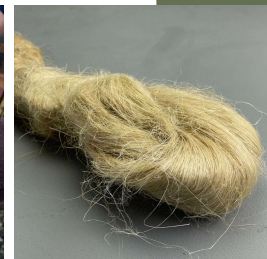
Wool – cheapest, homegrown, processed and woven into fabric.

WOOL



Flax – more labour intensive, possible to make in village setting, greyish but if sun-bleached, lighter

FLAX



Lets start with materials, this is what a fabric is made of and processed into something that can be woven into thread for weaving
Materials were commonly homegrown, or shared in villages. So sheep for wool and flax for linen.

Flax is interesting because the process to make yarn out of it is very labour intensive, its kind of hard like long grasses and need to be beaten repeatedly to become soft and workable

Knitting was less common than weaving, first nalbinding, from 14th, two needle knitting

Materials

Silk – Imported from Asia or produced in Byzantine from the 6th century. From the 12th century also in Europe.

Labor intensive, multi-stage process. Killing the pupae.

SILK



Leather & Fur– Long and stinky process

Thorough cleaning, softening/ preserving with lime and treated with dog/chicken poop.

LEATHER/FUR



[Silk source 1](#)

[Silk source 2](#)

[Leather source](#)

[Tanning video](#)

And then the more expensive materials are silk which was imported from asia or the byzantine empire

The silk process is very labor intensive and kills the worms inside the cocoons while giving relatively little yarn to work with

And then theres leather and fur, this was a very stinky process which could take weeks to turn a hide into leather

I have linked a video in the top right if you're interested, the process shown is a little more modern but still shows how much needs to happen before the hide is usable leather

Fabrics - Basic

Wool - THE medieval fabric (80% of clothing)

- Heavy, warm, naturally water-resistant
- Drapes with weight, holds shape
- Felts when wet = armour padding (gambeson)

Linen - Second most common

- Made from flax, cooler than wool
- Crisp when new, softens with wear
- Underlayers (touches skin)



And now the fabrics made from these materials

Each of the fabrics has its own properties, making it suitable for different things

Wool - THE medieval fabric (80% of clothing)

Heavy, warm, naturally water-resistant because of the natural oils in the wool,
Drapes with weight, holds shape

Felts when wet = and was used for armour padding in gambesons, Wool holds dye really well

There's also black wool, naturally from black sheep, which made black garments possible

Linen - Second most common

Made from flax, cooler than wool, Crisp and stiff when new, and softens with wear

The more you wear dyed linen, the lighter it becomes, it doesn't hold dye well,
Underlayers (touches skin)

Fabrics - Medieval

Silk - RARE and expensive (imported from Asia/Byzantine)

- Luxury only, nobility/royalty
- Smooth, lustrous, drapes fluidly



LEATHER:

- Vegetable-tanned (stiff, can be moulded)
- Different thicknesses: clothing vs. armour vs. belts



FUR:

- Status symbol, warmth
- Types by class

Silk - RARE and expensive (imported from Asia/Byzantine)

Luxury only, nobility/royalty, Smooth, lustrous, drapes fluidly, Highly breathable, temperature regulation, moisture absorption, Lightweight, beautiful sheen

LEATHER:

Vegetable-tanned (stiff, can be moulded), Different thicknesses made it possible to make many things from it like: clothing, armour, belts and shoes

FUR:

Was Status symbol, and gave warmth, Types by class: Bear/wolf (noble) vs. rabbit/sheepskin for peasant

Fabrics – Renaissance additions

Still used: Silk, linen, wool, leather/fur

Cotton – Rare at first, Italy production expanded to Germany (1600s).

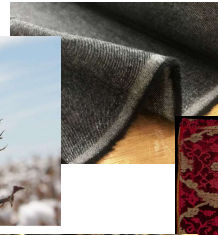
- Imported from India, Arabia, later Italian
- Very breathable, soft, durable, easy to dye

Velvet – From Italy after 14th century

- Specialised loom weaving with 2 layers simultaneously
- Primary indicator of wealth and power
- Woven-in patterns like pomegranates, eastern designs

Brocade & damask – 15th-16th century Italy

- Primarily silk, complex weaving with gold/silver

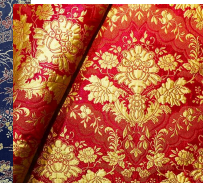


Cotton source



Velvet panel Italian 16th century >

[\[link\]](#)



During the renaissance, they still used wool and linen. But also some new fabric production methods were introduced to Europe
Italy was on the frontlines of textile productions, as they had maritime networks to eastern countries for the raw materials and new techniques
So while fabrics like silk, velvet, cotton, brocade could be imported earlier than the 14th century, the cost was so high that it was rarely done.
From the 14th century, Italy started their production and these expensive fabrics became more available.

Dyes & colours

UNDYED = PEASANT:

- Natural cream/beige (linen)
- Natural gray/brown (wool)
- Cost-effective, practical



Then we get to dyes, as I said before this also showed how wealthy you were and was connected to what was accessible

Peasants often wore undyed garments, so these neutral colours came from the raw product

Dyes & colours

COMMON/CHEAP:

- **Browns/Tans:** Walnut, oak bark (natural, everywhere)
- **Yellows:** Weld, onion skins
- **Greens:** Mixing blue + yellow (woad + weld)
- **Grays:** Undyed or mixing
- **Blues:** Woad (local European), indigo (imported, more expensive)
- **Reds:** Madder root (medium red-orange)

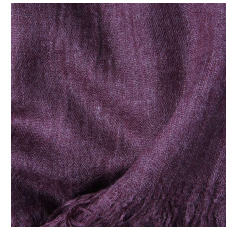


A bunch of plants could be used to dye your clothing
So it depended on what was available in the area. For example, if the farmland gave onions, clothing could be dyed yellow from the skins.
You can use plant availability in your game story to connect costume to nature.
Think about what could be farmed or available to dye from.

Dyes & colours

EXPENSIVE/RARE:

- **Purple:** Tyrian purple (10,000+ snails per gram! = ROYALTY ONLY)
- **Deep Scarlet:** Cochineal insects (imported)
- **Rich Blues:** High-quality indigo



During the renaissance period, dying became easier but not many new colours of dyestuffs were introduced. So the colours of these two periods stay the same
These colours seen here are

Natural indigo is a dye derived from the leaves of plants, primarily *Indigofera tinctoria*, through a process of fermentation and oxidation that extracts the compound indigotin

Why this matters for games

- Material behaviour
- Colour palette
- Weathering
- Believability



English medieval 1200s



English medieval 1300s

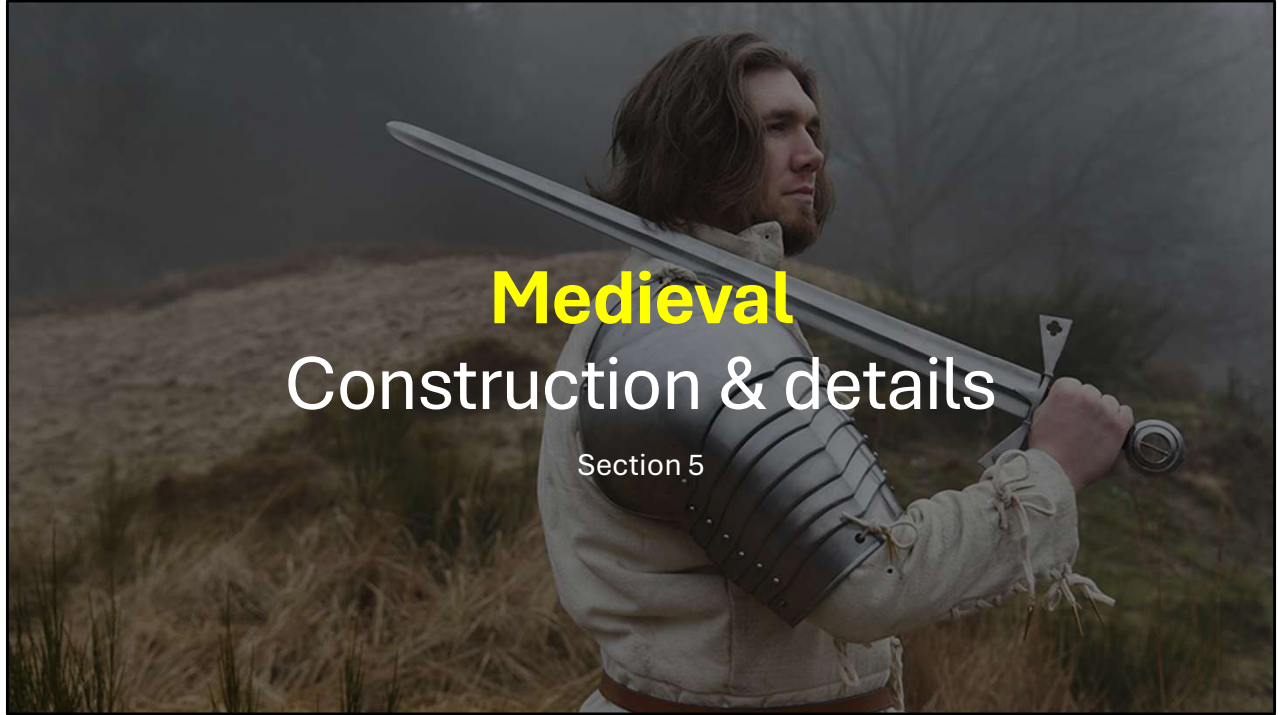
Source

Material behavior: Wool folds differently than silk = different cloth physics

Color palette: Medieval scenes should be mostly earth tones + occasional rich colour pops

Weathering: Wool pills, linen frays, leather cracks

Believability: Purple peasant = historically wrong



The next topic I want to tell you about is construction and details of these outfits

Practical wear in medieval

- Gussets! Allows for full range of movement
 - Loose, but not too much fabric
 - Simple closures
 - Layering
 - Durable construction
 - Grime-hiding colours
-
- Calf wrappings
 - Hoods and cloaks
 - Aprons



Gussets under arms and at crotch allow full range of movement (raising arms, bending, squatting) without tearing fabric - essential for manual labour

Loose, ample fabric in tunics and dresses provides freedom of movement for farm work, crafts, and daily tasks without restriction

Simple closures (ties, drawstrings, basic pins) that can be fastened/unfastened quickly and repaired easily without specialist help

Layering system adapts to weather - base layer (chemise/shirt), middle layer (tunic/dress), outer layer (cloak/cape) can be added or removed as needed

Durable construction with flat-felled seams that won't unravel from heavy use and can be mended multiple times

Design for Function:

Calf wrappings (leg bindings) protect lower legs, keep trousers from dragging in mud, provide warmth without bulk

Hoods attached to cloaks serve as hat, scarf, and rain protection in one piece

Aprons for specific work tasks protect the clothing underneath (blacksmith, baker, farmer each had appropriate apron)

Practicality take-aways

- Layering for adaptability
- Materials suited to environment
- Work influences outfit
- Prioritize movement



Some takeaways in terms of practicality of medieval worker clothes are Layering, they did this for adaptability to weather, season and work they had to do

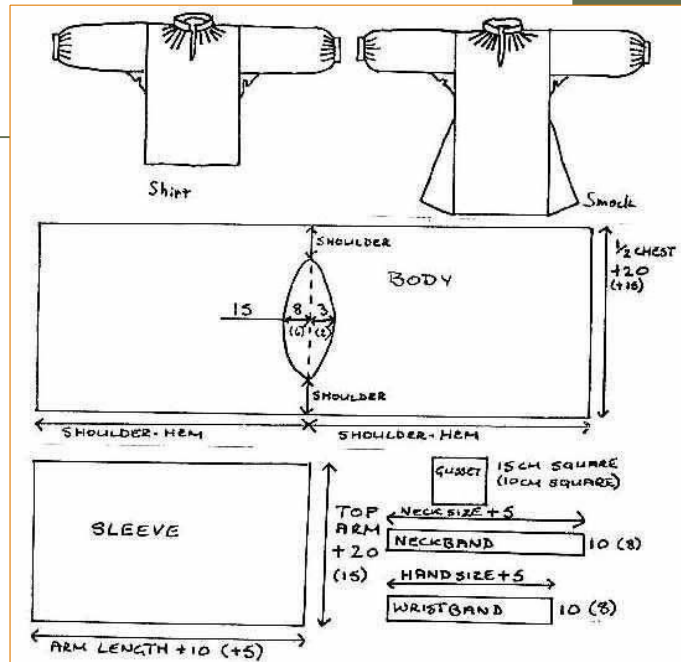
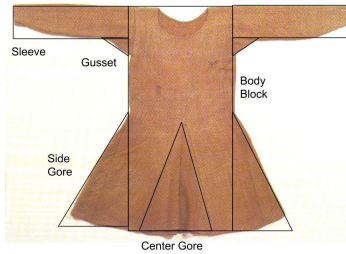
They used materials suited for the environment, so linen in summer and wool overlays in winter

What work you did heavily influences your outfit as it needs to be easy to move in and not in the way of manual labour

Construction & details

THE TUNIC (Foundation of Everything):

- Pattern = Simple T-shape or rectangles:
 - Front panel (*rectangle*)
 - Back panel (*rectangle*)
 - Sleeves (*rectangles or trapezoids*)
 - Gores/gussets for movement
 - Lacing/ties for closure



The tunic is one of the most common garments in the medieval period

At this time they didn't really know how to tailor clothing yet and everything was hand and homemade

So you started with some rectangles, and added triangles and other shapes to it so it would fit the body comfortably

No stretch fabrics were used yet so these extra pieces gave you freedom of movement, bending and wearing it comfortably

Key Construction Elements:

Gores (Triangular inserts), Added to skirts for flare/movement, Added to sleeves for elbow bend, **Animation:** Natural fold points, affects drape direction

Gussets (Diamond/square inserts), Underarm (allows arm raising), Crotch (allows leg movement), **Animation:** Without these, fabric pulls tight - WITH these, fabric has slack for movement

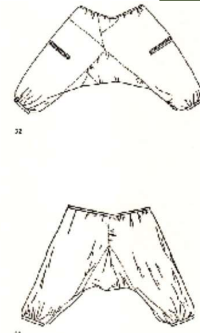
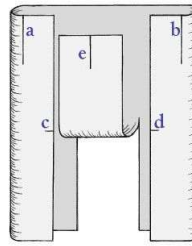
Lacing/Ties (Primary closure), Front, side, or back lacing, Adjustable fit,

Animation: Lacing stretches slightly with movement, creates directional pull

Construction & details

The Pants

- Enveloping fabric patterns
- Breeches worn over pants, attached with string to waistbelt
- They didn't know how to make pant closures
- No stretch in fabric needs more fabric in order to get into the garment



This is how pants were made early medieval times

They had to use lots of fabric as they didn't know how to make closures yet
So it all bunched up around the upper legs otherwise you cant get into the garment if the waistband is too fitting

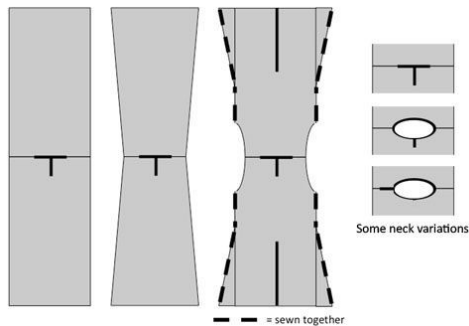
They would wrap their legs in wrapping to make it not get in the way

Or wear tighter breeches like the bottom right image, which were tied to the waistband to hold them up

Construction & details

Surcoat

- Simple rectangle shaped
- Sleeveless
- Worn over tunic for warmth or alliance (battle)



Over the tunic, they often wore surcoats. This is a sleeveless rectangle with a hole for your head

This garment adds more warmth while not getting in the way

For soldiers they would often use alliance colours or add emblems to show for which team they fought

Construction & details

Armour construction

Gambeson (Quilted Armour):

- Two layers fabric + padding
- Quilted in channels
- Holds shape, compresses when struck, doesn't drape freely



A gambeson is an interesting Armour construction made from fabric

It has Two layers fabric + with padding (wool, linen) in between

Then Quilted in channels (vertical or diamond pattern)

They often wore their chainmail over thinner gambesons for shock absorbtion

Construction & details

Chainmail:

- Individual rings linked
- Weighs 15-20kg
- Follows body closely, heavy drape, rings shift over each other (ripple effect)



Plate Armour:

- Individual articulated plates
- Leather straps underneath
- Each plate moves SEPARATELY



Chainmail: is Individual rings linked and Weighs 15-20kg (so it drapes with WEIGHT)

Plate armour is made from individual plates that can move over and under the next, this allows movement possible

Construction & details

Cuirass (chest): Rigid

- Pauldrons (shoulders): Pivot at shoulder joint
- Vambraces (arms): Rotate with forearm
- Faulds (waist): Overlap plates that slide over each other



Medieval

Construction & details

Closures

- Lacing (most common)
- Buttons (expensive, later period)
- Pins/brooches (cloaks)



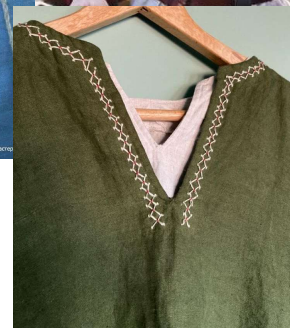
[Buttons source](#)

For closures they used lacing, pulling a string through holes
And later they would use buttons, these were wooden balls covered in fabric
They also used brooches but I don't know how historically accurate that image is,
but you can see how they would've been used

Construction & details

Necklines, cuffs, and others:

- Drawstring (gathers when pulled)
- Split opening (front or side)
- Fabric bunches around drawstring
- Strings holding breeches up
- Belts and wrappings



Other details worth mentioning are drawstrings, like the neckline of the red dress top right

Split openings, kind of like a v neck which offers more space to get in and out of the garment

And a lot more strings to hold things up and tie them to other garments or belts as there were no elastics yet

Critical detail points:

Necklines:

Drawstring (gathers when pulled), Split opening (front or side), **Animation:** Fabric bunches around drawstring

Sleeves:

Set-in sleeve: Gathers at shoulder cap, Raglan/draped: Follows shoulder line,

Animation: Gathers pull fabric in specific directions

Hems:

Often weighted (helps drape), Raw edge or turned up, **Animation:** Weighted hem swings differently than unweighted



Renaissance Construction & details

Section 5

Then for the renaissance

Practical wear in renaissance

- Prioritize movement
- Workwear, withstand rigorous daily tasks
- Looks a lot like medieval wear, but more fashionable (codpiece, bodice, kirtle)
- Still using gussets
- More shaped
- Simplified fashion
- Kirtle for women, fashionable but workable



This Continued Medieval Practicality

They still prioritized movement and layered their clothing

Gussets were still essential to add space to garments for manual labour and freedom of movement

But the garments became more shaped and looked like simplified versions of what was in fashion for the nobles and rich people

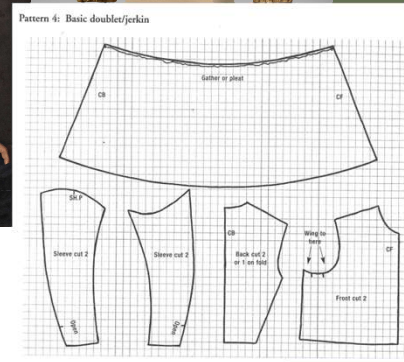
Tunics got more shoulder emphasis and women's tunics became kirtles, which were inspired by bodices and stays of the noble women

In terms of fabrics, wool and linen remained dominant and garments were practical adaptations of the very unpractical garments nobles wore

Construction & details

The doublet

- Front panels (2 pieces, shaped for chest/waist suppression)
- Back panels (2-4 pieces, centre back seam + side back seams for shaping)
- Sleeves (2 pieces each, shaped with elbow curve, set-in sleeve cap)
- Collar/neckband (separate piece, stands away from neck)
- Optional: Peplum/skirt sections (attached at waist, creates flare)



For renaissance men, a doublet was the most important garment

This was a close fitting and padded jacket which was originally derived from gambesons, but make it fashion

It emphasises the narrow waist while increasing belly size with padding

These jackets had buttons or laces so you could tie your pants to it, so it stayed up

Construction & details

Hose with codpiece

- Front of the hose has a long slit opening
- Codpiece overlay
- Secured with buttons or ribbons
- Display of manlyhood
- Secret pocket for money or medicine



Here's a pants design, the green pants is the more simplified version of the gold yellow pants.

They started making tight fitting pants but if you sewed the crotch seam closed, you wouldn't be able to get in

So they added cod pieces, these are triangular pieces that you could open for dressing or going to the toilet

These cod pieces had padded phallic shapes added to them, and these showed fertility and wealth.

These pieces were often used as pockets and people would keep money of medicine (for syphilis) in them.

The bodies/stay

- Front panels (1 or 2 pieces, curved for bust shaping and waist suppression)
- Side front panels (2 pieces, angles inward at waist)
- Side back panels (2 pieces, continues waist shaping)
- Back panels (2 pieces, centre back seam for lacing)
- Boning channels



For womens, the stiff bodies was the most prominent garment

The garment had rows and rows of boning channels and filled with straw, whale bones or wood

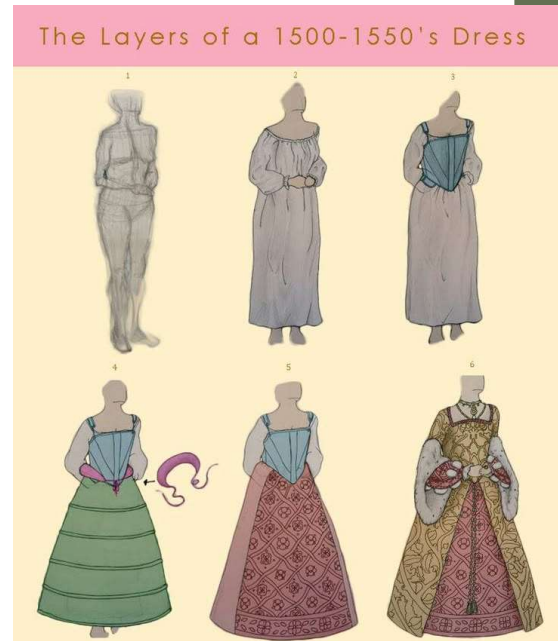
This made the garment quite stiff and it held you very upright and it was hard to breathe in

This showed you didn't have to work because you were very rich

This was the predecessor of the Victorian corset which is the special topic of next week

Layering was important

- Chemise
- Bodies
- Hoop skirt / farthingale
- Overskirt
- Gown



In the renaissance, layering was important.

Starting with a chemise and a bodies

Then a hoop skirt of farthingale and lastly the layer of gown that was actually visible for others

Keywords of renaissance womens wear

Hoopskirt



Farthingale



Kirtle



Bodies / stays



Here is some more information about the skirts and what each one looked like
These under structures were a display of wealth, because excessive fabric usage showed you were wealthy
This was also a period of lots of sickness like syphilis so these skirts also distanced you from others

Medieval

Construction & details

Closures

- Lacing (most common)
- Buttons (expensive, later period)

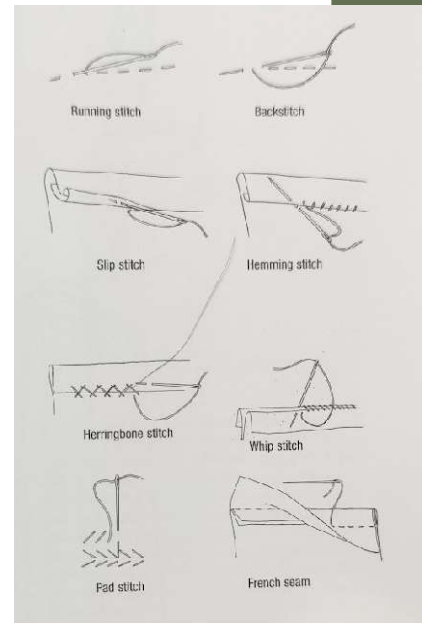
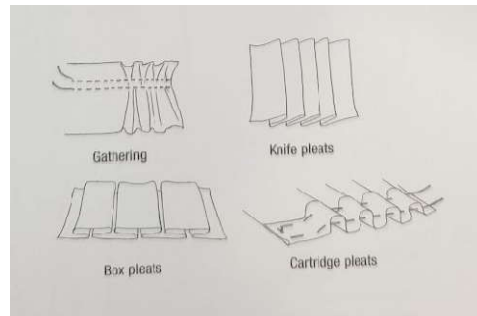
[Spiral lacing source](#)



For closures they still used lacing and improved their buttons
Lacing was done in a zigzag pattern with just one string from top to bottom.
In the next period you will see crisscross lacing becoming popular but not in the renaissance yet

Construction details

- All clothing was hand-stitched
- Different kinds of seaming
- Pleating and gathering was used a lot

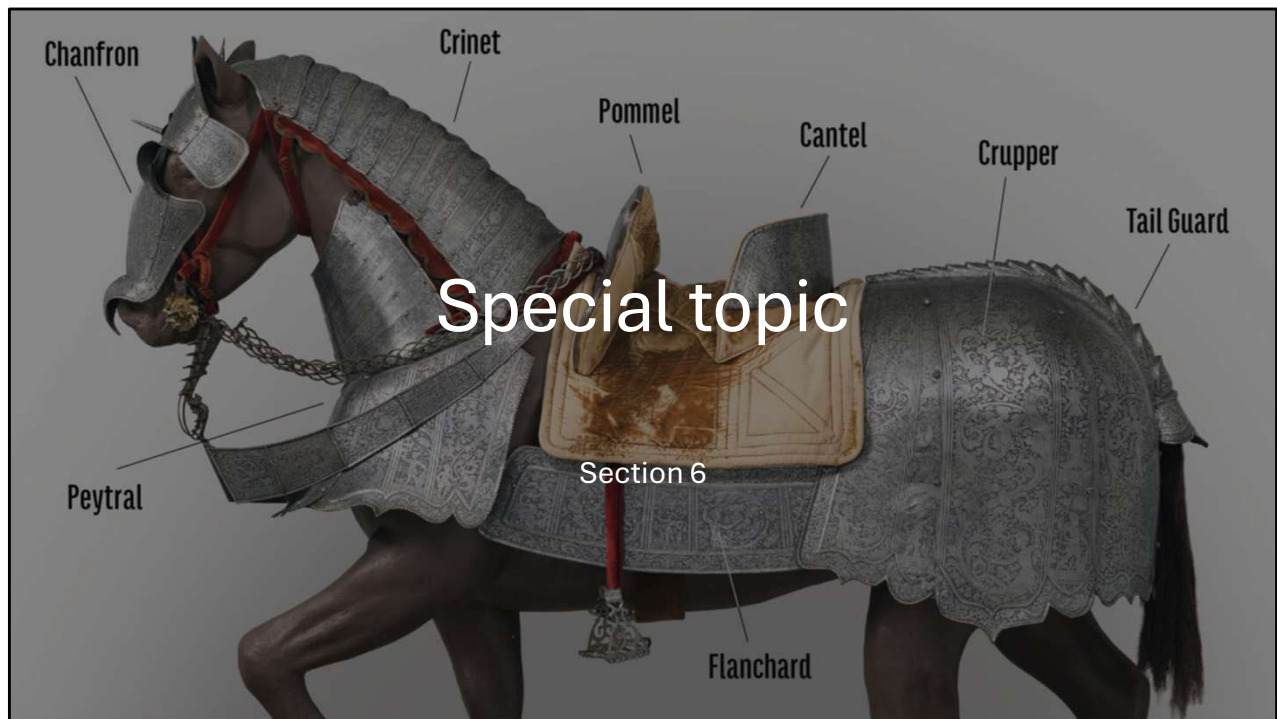


Another interesting construction detail is the stitching

Everything was hand stitched of course and you can see in the image to the right how each stitch is called

You can google this and learn more about how that looks in 3D and how you might be able to put it in your work

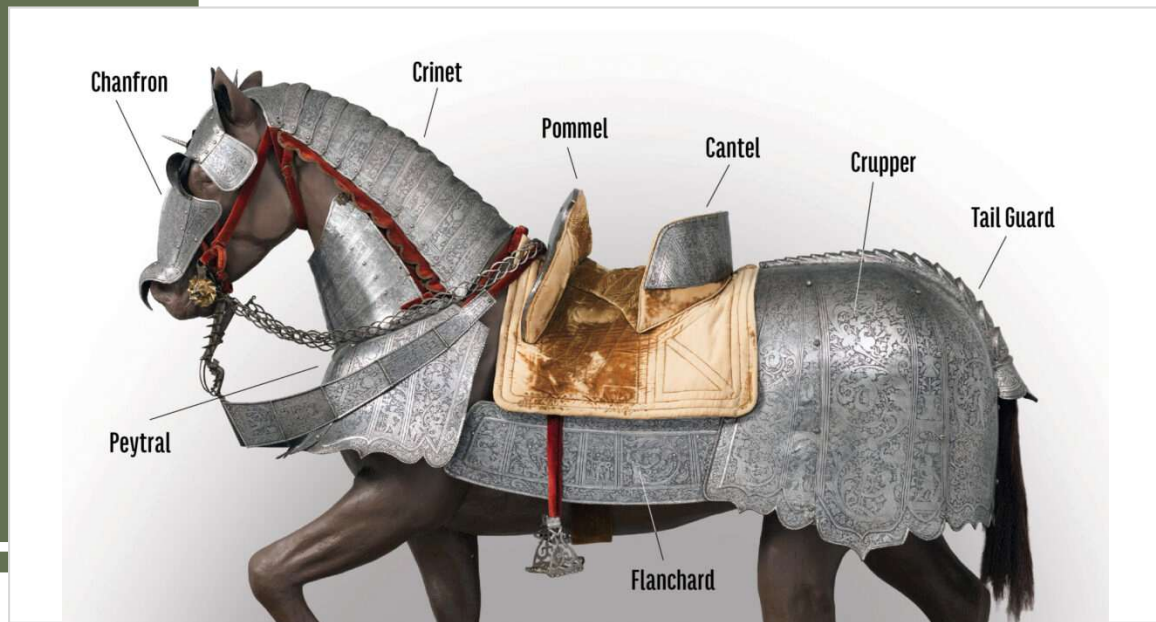
Pleating and gathering was also used a lot to make the large amount of fabric manageable. You can see some keywords on the bottom image



Alright, almost at the end of the session
The special topic of this week is horse and mount tack

Source image: <https://www.historynet.com/an-inside-look-at-medieval-horse-armor/>

Tack components - armour



Horses sometimes wore armour when going into battle and this image shows how each piece is called if you want to do more research

Saddle and tack components



Bridle, reins, stirrups



A caparison



War saddle

[Link](#)

They used very decorated tack components, especially if you were a noble knight.

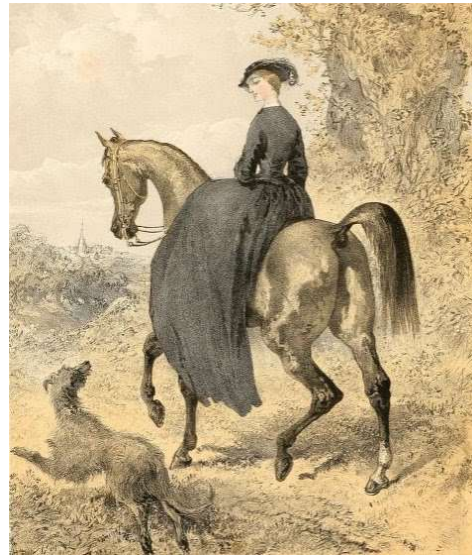
These were made of fabric and showed your alliance

The saddles were still made from wood at this point, covered with fabric. The link in the bottom right is of the MET museum, has some very interesting pieces you can look at

How rider clothing interacts with tack



Horse barding



Google horse barding for modern inspiration

When designing a character on a horse, you need to keep in mind how the riders clothing will interact with the horse and it's tack
Theres this modern trend called horse barding, this can give you nice references for fabrics on horses and its riders

Game application

When designing a mounted character, ask:

- Can they actually SIT in this?
- What happens to their cloak/cape when mounted?
- Is the tack appropriate for their social status?
- Does the saddle make sense for this mount's anatomy?
- Where do their weapons go when riding?



FF Chocobo



DA:I Nuggalope

When designing different mounts than horses there's a few things you need to ask yourself

Can they actually SIT in this? (Hip flexibility, thigh clearance)

What happens to their cloak/cape when mounted? (Drapes to sides, can snag)

Is the tack appropriate for their social status? (Rich = fancy, poor = basic)

Does the saddle make sense for this mount's anatomy?

Where do their weapons go when riding? (Scabbard positions, lance holders)



That was the theory of this session, now its time for the discussion and reflection

Reflection prompt

Based on today's workshop, identify 2-3 costume design principles from medieval/Renaissance period that you think would be useful for your game character/concept work.

For each one, briefly describe:

- What the principle is
- How you might apply it (either in current project or hypothetically)
- Why this would improve your character design

List of principles:

- Defining silhouette
- Key garments
- Visual markers of status
 - Layers, fabric, colour, ornamentation
- Fabrics & dyes
- Construction
 - Gussets
 - Practicality
- Horse tack / mounts

So a little activity for you guys,

Based on today's workshop, identify 2-3 costume design principles from medieval/Renaissance period that you think would be useful for your game character/concept work.

For each one, briefly describe:

What the principle is

How you might apply it (either in current project or hypothetically)

Why this would improve your character design

Next guild:

Victorian and industrial era
1800 – 1900s

This is when clothing became engineered, Victorian construction was the goat, teaches you how clothing actually works



The next guild is about the Victorian and industrial era

This is when clothing became engineered and they started using tailored patterns

And eventually started mass producing fabric and garments because of industrialisation

Sources

Clothes in Medieval England – World history encyclopaedia [\[link\]](#)

Garment references from paintings - Fashion history timeline [\[link\]](#)

Horse armour in Europe – The Met Museum [\[link\]](#)

Video: Tudor men's fashion explained in 8 minutes – 1485-1603 [\[link\]](#)

Brocade fabric Europe till 1500s – Met museum [\[link\]](#)

Velvet fabric Europe till 1500s – Met museum [\[link\]](#)

I've added some more interesting sources about this topic.